

Early wireless tech

In 1895, when Marconi began conducting experiments in wireless signals he was only able to send signals from one end of the room to other

Edison improved on an idea

In popular imagination, Thomas Alva Edison was the inventor of the light bulb, but the truth is that he only improved upon an existing idea

Technologies of Tomorrow

What did we learn this decade that will change the next?

Anoop Verma

readersletters@thinkdigit.com

Technology is like a magic carpet, one that is imbued with incredible powers of taking us to a new way of life. Smartphones are now a part of our lives, but about a decade ago it might have been difficult for us to imagine that we would one day be moving around with phones that are as powerful as many PCs. The concept of connectivity and networking on the go has also spread at a scorching pace and it has brought about a seminal change in our perception of the world. There is no doubt that we are going to be greeted by even more interesting technologies. Scientists are busy planning products that will bring a new dimension to our lives by enabling us to do things in new ways. Here is a look at some of the innovations that could become part of our lives during the next decade:

The evolution of the Touchscreen

When the first Apple iPhone landed in our hands, the touchscreen on it did seem like a sort of futuristic technology. But future always has a tendency to surprise. The touchscreen we might be using during the next decade might turn out to be a lot more advanced. How about a foldable touchscreen! You could roll it into a neat bundle and tuck it in one corner of your handbag, and when you want to use it, you simply spread it out on a flat surface. Currently a concept laptop is under development whose body, from one end to other, consists of a single touchscreen; it can be bent, so that one part of the touchscreen starts acting like a normal screen, while the other will

showcase the usual set of keyboard buttons. Apple, Dell and many other top tech companies are at the forefront of the race to enhance the capabilities of the touchscreen. Another tech major, Qualcomm, recently filed a patent for an interesting tablet, which is made out of three touchscreens. So you can rest assured that there is a touch-bonanza waiting for you.

Cars, laptops and mobile batteries that last longer

All of us have been through those frustrating occasions when we had the mobile, laptop or even the car battery conking off on us. You have to plug these gizmos to the mains after every few hours. But in the years to come, we might have batteries that are much more pow-



Advanced batteries

erful. Scientists are conducting their research on many different lines. There is a research currently on at University of Maryland that envisages the usage of nanotechnology to store electrical energy in batteries for very long periods of time. Batteries that can be charged in just six minutes are also under development. In case of car batteries, really innovative ideas are being

contemplated. For instance, Volvo and few European carmakers have teamed up with the Imperial College, London, to develop cars that could use their own bodywork as a battery. The same technology could also be used for laptops and mobiles. Instead of having a separate battery, the body of these gadgets could serve as a very long lasting battery.

Smell your TV

When the small screen is showcasing visuals of piping hot food being pulled out of the oven, you often get struck by the longing of being able to smell the food. In few years, you might as well be able to fulfil this wish. Along with titillating your eyes and ears, the TV of the future might also pack the technology for reaching out to your olfactory senses. Currently under development is a system called SMELLIT, a brainchild of Nuno Teixeira. The technology closely resembles the working of an inkjet printer. Only in this case, the cartridges will be loaded with 118 individual smells. Once SMELL IT has been activated, it will automatically process the DVD or television signals, and release the relevant smells 10 or 20 seconds before the actual scene. The advance release is to allow the



SMELL IT!